

Unit 1: Introduction to Geography as a Discipline

Reading: pages 7–21 · 20 points · 15 minutes · Closed book

Name _____

Date _____

Score / 20

Answer every question. For multiple choice, circle the single best answer. Write short answers in complete sentences.

Part A · Multiple Choice

6 questions × 2 points = 12 points

1. What sets geography apart from other academic disciplines?
 - a) Its focus on spatial inquiry and analysis
 - b) Its reliance on laboratory experiments rather than fieldwork
 - c) Its exclusive study of human cultures
 - d) Its focus on how societies change over long periods of time
2. In the farmer's no-till experiment described in the text, the amount of soil erosion that the farmer measures is the
 - a) hypothesis
 - b) independent variable
 - c) experimental control
 - d) dependent variable
3. A hypothesis becomes a scientific theory when
 - a) a scientist has proven it beyond a shadow of a doubt
 - b) it explains all the collected data and none of the data contradicts it
 - c) it has been published in a textbook
 - d) at least three independent scientists agree with it
4. Which of the following is a *great circle*?
 - a) The Tropic of Cancer
 - b) The Arctic Circle
 - c) The Equator
 - d) The 45th parallel north
5. Latitude is best described as
 - a) an angular measurement north or south of the equator
 - b) the distance in miles east or west of the Prime Meridian
 - c) a small circle that divides the Earth into two equal halves
 - d) a line connecting points on the Earth's surface

6. Because the Earth rotates 360 degrees in a 24-hour period, each of the world's 24 time zones ideally spans
- a) 7.5 degrees of longitude
 - b) 15 degrees of longitude
 - c) 23.5 degrees of longitude
 - d) 30 degrees of longitude

Part B · True or False

2 questions × 1 point = 2 points

7. Longitude is measured east and west of the International Date Line.
TRUE / FALSE
8. Remote sensing is the ability to study objects without being in direct physical contact with them.
TRUE / FALSE

Part C · Short Answer

2 questions × 3 points = 6 points

9. Explain the difference between *absolute location* and *relative location*. Give one example of each.
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10. A geographic information system (GIS) works from two different spatial models. Name both, and explain how they differ.
